

BUILDING THE CENTER OF EXCELLENCE FOR POWER PLATFORM

DESIGNING THE COMMUNITY HUB

**A BLUEPRINT FOR A SCALABLE HUB THAT ENABLES A SELF-
SUSTAINING COMMUNITY**

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Designing the Community Hub

A Blueprint for a Scalable Hub That Enables a Self-Sustaining Community

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*A Community Hub becomes valuable not when it gives people another place to visit,
but when it makes the Center of Excellence visible, accessible, and actionable in their
everyday work.*

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Prologue

Most Power Platform Centers of Excellence eventually encounter the same contradiction. The governance framework is documented, the training plan exists, and the administrative reports show that the platform is being used. Yet makers still do not know where to ask for help, champions lose momentum because nobody has organized around them, business owners struggle to understand their responsibilities, and the Center of Excellence continues to answer the same questions through isolated messages. The organization has created the components of adoption, but it has not created the place where those components become visible and usable.

This paper accompanies *Defining the Framework Structure for the Power Platform Center of Excellence* and *Copilot Studio and the Future of the Power Platform Center of Excellence*. The first establishes the wider framework for sustainable adoption, in which the Centers of Governance, Innovation, and Enablement form the execution layer, the Innovation Hub acts as a point of convergence between the three, and operations, support, and maintenance form the sustainability layer. The second reframes training, community, enabling assets, and responsible use for an era in which makers build both applications and agents. The present paper addresses a narrower gap. It takes the community-facing surface of that framework and develops it into a practical reference design, from audiences and capabilities to request routing, technical architecture, licensing considerations, mockups, implementation phases, and residual risks.

This is not official Microsoft guidance, a product deployment manual, or a substitute for either book. It does not claim that every organization should use the same technologies in the same way. It offers one coherent pattern for an internal Community Hub and makes its assumptions visible so that a Center of Excellence can adopt, adapt, or reject each decision deliberately. Official product documentation remains authoritative for configuration, licensing, security, limits, and supportability.

The primary readers are Center of Excellence Leads, enablement leads, Power Platform administrators, community managers, solution architects, business owners, and executive sponsors. Readers evaluating the argument should focus on Chapters 1 through 4. Readers translating the model into operating processes should concentrate on Chapters 5 through 7. Architects and administrators can go directly to Chapters 8 through 10 once the audience, pillar, and routing decisions are understood. Teams already operating a Community Hub may use Chapters 11 through 13 as an implementation and reassessment checklist. Chapter 14 records the provenance of the source material and the limits of the evidence used.

The manuscript describes every proposed figure in detail. Those descriptions are production specifications, not final visual designs. They explain the purpose of each figure, the information it must contain, the intended reading order, the relationships it must make visible, and the message a reader should retain. A later design stage may change colors, typography, dimensions, or visual style, but it should not alter the conceptual structure without an explicit editorial decision.

1. Why a Community Hub, specifically

Power Platform and Copilot Studio adoption often fails not because the organization lacks licenses, but because people lack a reliable place where governance, learning, support, recognition, and improvement come together. The Community Hub is that place, provided it is designed as an operating surface rather than another communications site.

A Center of Excellence can publish policies, create training courses, define environment strategies, and monitor platform activity. Each of those actions is necessary, but none automatically creates a coherent experience for the community. From the user's perspective, the distinction between governance content, technical guidance, training, support, and community engagement is less important than a more immediate question: where do I go now? If the answer depends on knowing the internal structure of the Center of Excellence, adoption has already become harder than it needs to be.

The Community Hub gives the framework a front door. A new maker should be able to discover approved patterns, understand the environments available, identify the first learning path, and request help without first learning the organization's operating model. A citizen developer should be able to find advanced patterns, sandbox rules, certification expectations, and an escalation route. A champion should be able to see upcoming events, nominate peers, publish a success story, and locate the support needed to mentor others. A business owner should be able to understand ownership, value, lifecycle, and retirement obligations. A platform administrator should be able to direct non-administrative questions away from the administrative support queue without making the user feel rejected.

This does not mean that the Community Hub owns every process it exposes. Its value is partly navigational and partly operational. It hosts some capabilities directly, such as curated knowledge, onboarding, champion information, and community-facing metrics. It initiates other processes and sends them to the correct accountable function. An idea belongs to the Innovation Hub. An environment request belongs to Sustain. A training request belongs to the Center of Enablement. A solution retirement request belongs to application maintenance within Sustain. The user experiences one coherent entry point, while the Center of Excellence preserves distinct accountabilities behind it.

The distinction between a place and a page matters. A page displays content. A place supports recurring behavior. It has recognizable ownership, navigation, service expectations, lifecycle rules, measurement, feedback, and a reason for people to return. If the organization launches a polished home page but leaves content ownership ambiguous, request routes unresolved, and feedback disconnected from a backlog, the page will decay. If it launches a modest surface with clear jobs, named owners, and reliable follow-through, it can grow into a durable operating asset.

The Community Hub also creates observability. Repeated search queries, assistant topics, abandoned forms, common escalations, training requests, and feedback patterns reveal where the community is struggling. That evidence allows the Center of Excellence to improve content, change a policy explanation, design a

new learning path, revise a request form, or identify a process that is creating unnecessary friction. In this sense, the Community Hub is not only a delivery channel. It is a listening system.

The expected outcome is not traffic for its own sake. Page views, session counts, and assistant conversations may help operators understand usage, but they are not the final measure of success. The more meaningful outcomes are faster access to reliable answers, clearer ownership, fewer misrouted requests, greater reuse of approved patterns, visible recognition of community contribution, and better evidence for improvement decisions. The Community Hub should reduce uncertainty, not merely accumulate visits.

2. The four pillars of sustainable adoption

Every capability in the Community Hub should support one of four pillars: continuous training, scalable governance and support, active community and engagement, or evolution strategy. A capability that cannot be mapped to a pillar needs a stronger justification or should not be part of the Community Hub.

The first pillar, continuous training, recognizes that adoption is not a one-time enablement event. People enter the ecosystem with different roles, experience levels, and intended outcomes. Their needs change as they move from using a solution to building one, from building simple personal productivity tools to creating governed business applications, and from creating deterministic automation to designing agents that interpret information and interact with users. A single introductory course cannot support that progression.

Continuous training therefore combines formal and informal mechanisms. It includes role-based learning paths, quick-start guides, curated external learning, internal workshops, office hours, mentoring, hackathons, pattern walkthroughs, certification guidance, and learning that emerges from actual community questions. The Community Hub does not need to deliver all instruction itself. It needs to organize the learning journey, make the next step visible, and connect each profile with the right depth of content and support.

The second pillar, scalable governance and support, makes growth safe and repeatable. Governance becomes scalable when policy is translated into understandable choices, approved patterns are easier to reuse than to reinvent, and service requests arrive with enough information to be routed and processed. Support becomes scalable when common questions can be answered from governed knowledge, peer help is encouraged within clear boundaries, and specialist escalation remains available for issues that require authority or deep expertise.

Continuous training

Ongoing, role-differentiated learning built from personalized paths, mentoring, events, patterns, and practical experience.

Scalable governance and support

Policies, standards, environments, service routes, and reusable patterns that let adoption grow without losing control.

Active community and engagement

A structured social space in which champions, makers, owners, and specialists share knowledge and recognize contribution.

Evolution strategy

Feedback, KPIs, backlog management, and coordination that keep the platform, the Community Hub, and the operating model relevant.

Figure 1. The four pillars of sustainable adoption.

The third pillar, active community and engagement, creates the social system through which expertise spreads. Communities become self-sustaining when participants can ask questions, share practical experience, recognize helpful contributions, find champions, attend events, and see evidence that participation matters. The Center of Excellence still provides structure, moderation, and escalation, but it

does not remain the only source of answers. Champions, makers, owners, and specialists contribute within a governed community space.

The fourth pillar, evolution strategy, prevents the Community Hub and the platform around it from becoming static. It combines feedback, business-value measures, operational measures, an improvement backlog, changes in the Microsoft platform, and coordination with adjacent functions such as data, artificial intelligence, automation, security, and architecture. The Community Hub itself must evolve. Content needs review dates, capabilities need usage evidence, routes need performance measures, and deferred choices need scheduled reassessment.

Agent adoption adds a behavioral dimension to all four pillars. Teaching Copilot Studio cannot be reduced to showing people where to click. Users and makers need to understand what an agent can and cannot do, which sources it uses, when a human must validate an answer, and who is accountable for the quality of grounded knowledge. An agent that confidently returns information from stale, incorrect, or ownerless content exposes a content governance problem, not only an artificial intelligence problem. Training, governance, community practice, and continuous improvement must all reinforce informed trust.

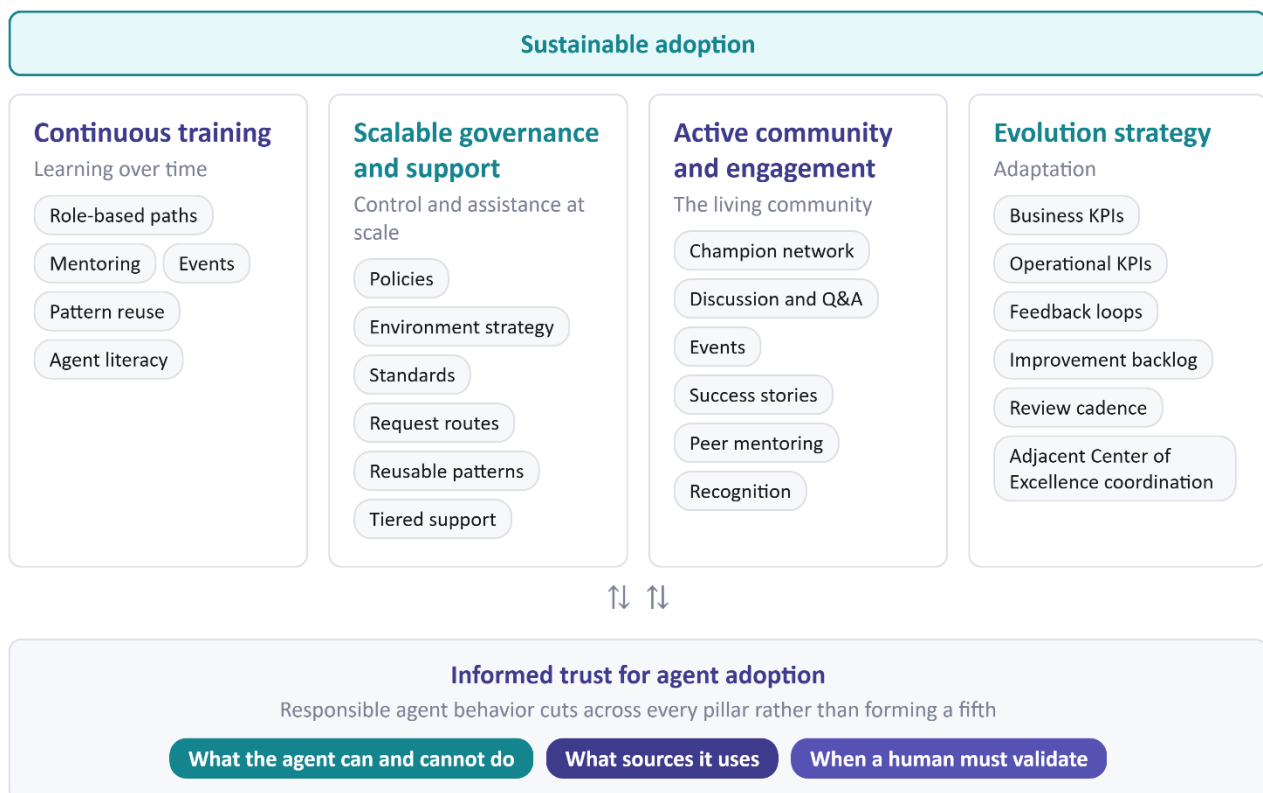


Figure 2. The four pillars and the informed-trust foundation.

3. Who the Community Hub actually serves

The Community Hub should be designed for distinct profiles with distinct jobs, risks, and levels of responsibility. Designing for an undefined audience called everyone usually produces generic content that serves nobody particularly well.

The end user or consumer arrives because an application, flow, report, or agent has already been published to them. This profile needs short guidance on how to use the solution, where to ask a question, how to report a problem, and how to give feedback. The experience should avoid exposing builder terminology unless it is necessary. If this profile is ignored, questions that should be answered through self-service or functional support flood the Center of Excellence and platform administration channels.

The maker typically has basic or intermediate knowledge and creates simple applications or automations for personal or team use. This profile benefits from ready-to-use templates, short patterns, environment guidance, reusable components, and a clear boundary for when a solution has become complex enough to require a different path. If the Community Hub serves makers only with broad documentation, each person rebuilds common solutions without a shared starting point.

The citizen developer is a more advanced builder who can create solutions with meaningful complexity without necessarily having deep traditional software development experience. This profile needs governed sandboxes, advanced patterns, architecture guidance, solution lifecycle expectations, certification pathways, and access to specialist support. Maker and citizen developer are related but not identical categories. Combining them hides the fact that a quick template may be sufficient for one and dangerously incomplete for the other.

The champion needs early visibility into platform and program developments, a clear role in the community, mentoring tools, recognition, and a route for escalating recurring community signals. Champions amplify the Center of Excellence, but they are not free operational capacity. If the role is undefined, unsupported, or dependent on personal enthusiasm alone, champions eventually burn out or develop inconsistent local practices.

The business owner is accountable for purpose, value, audience, continuity, and lifecycle. This profile needs guidance on expected benefits, value measures, ownership obligations, review cadence, escalation, and retirement. The Community Hub must make it difficult for a solution to enter production without a real owner and equally difficult for an owner to disappear without triggering reassignment or retirement review.

The platform administrator needs environment status, DLP references, managed environment signals, licensing and capacity information, and clear escalation paths. This profile should not become the default help desk for every platform-related question. The Community Hub should separate administrative issues from learning, functional use, maker support, and community discussion.

The Center of Excellence or support team operates the Community Hub. Its members need content ownership views, moderation mechanisms, request queues, workflow status, backlog visibility, assistant

analytics, KPI reporting, and governance review records. Without operational controls, the Community Hub itself becomes an unmanaged solution with stale information and unclear accountability.

The executive sponsor needs a portfolio-level narrative about adoption, value, risk, community health, and improvement. Detailed request counts may support the analysis, but sponsor reporting should translate activity into business-relevant outcomes. The Community Hub should help explain whether the organization is developing sustainable capability, not merely whether a page is being visited.

Community members

End user or consumer Comes for: usage guidance, questions, support, and feedback. Risk if ignored: avoidable support demand.	Maker Comes for: templates, quick patterns, and simple solutions. Risk if ignored: repeated reinvention.	Citizen developer Comes for: advanced patterns, sandbox access, learning depth, and certification. Risk if ignored: stalled progress or ungoverned complexity.	Champion Comes for: roadmap access, mentoring, recognition, and escalation of community signals. Risk if ignored: burnout or inconsistent local practice.
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Solution and platform accountability

Business owner Comes for: purpose, value, metrics, audience, ownership, escalation, and retirement. Risk if ignored: orphaned solutions.	Platform administrator Comes for: environments, DLP, licensing, capacity, governance signals, and administrative escalation. Risk if ignored: becoming the default help desk.
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Center of Excellence and leadership

Center of Excellence or support team Comes for: intake, moderation, content ownership, requests, analytics, and reporting. Risk if ignored: the Community Hub becomes an unmanaged solution.	Executive sponsor Comes for: portfolio value, adoption, and risk. Risk if ignored: activity is reported instead of outcomes.
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↪ Maker and citizen developer are related but not identical profiles: a quick template may be sufficient for one and dangerously incomplete for the other.

Figure 3. Audience and needs map.

The audience model should shape personalization. The first five minutes for a new end user should not look like the first five minutes for a champion or administrator. Personalization does not require a complex recommendation engine at launch. It can begin with role-selectable landing paths, targeted quick links, and clearly labeled sections. What matters is that the Community Hub makes role distinctions visible and does not force every profile through the same generic tour.

4. Programs, processes, and tools that condition the final solution

Architecture should begin with decisions about the organization's existing programs, processes, and collaboration surfaces. A Community Hub built without this inventory will either duplicate capabilities, route work into nonexistent functions, or assume governance services that are not actually present.

The Champions Program is the first dependency. If a formal or informal champion network exists, the Community Hub needs a directory, nomination and offboarding workflows, communication mechanisms, participation expectations, and a recognition model. If no network exists, the Community Hub can help establish one, but the Center of Excellence still needs to own recruitment and invitation. A technology surface cannot create voluntary leadership by itself.

The governance source of truth is the second dependency. The Power Platform admin center is the current native location for inventory, usage, monitoring, actions, and licensing visibility. Any design based on an actively maintained CoE Starter Kit dataflow would therefore inherit a deprecated assumption. The Community Hub may display selected indicators, but it should reference or consume supported governance signals rather than recreate them as a parallel truth.

The Innovation Hub is the third dependency. It coordinates the governance, development, and adoption sides of innovation: identifying opportunities, shaping ideas, governing experiments, building solutions, supporting adoption, and learning from outcomes. If it already exists, training, idea intake, champions, community-building, and adoption activities in the Community Hub should connect to it. If it does not exist, the Center of Excellence must decide whether the Community Hub will act as a visible precursor or whether those routes will remain explicitly pending.

Sustain is the fourth dependency. It includes platform operations, end-user support, citizen-developer support, solution maintenance, environment requests, migrations, backups, DLP exceptions, access, solution onboarding, and retirement. These are not idea-development activities. If established operational or tiered support teams already exist, the Community Hub should route to them. If they do not, the design must name the gap rather than hiding it behind a generic form.

Existing collaboration surfaces are the fifth dependency. Teams, Viva Engage, and SharePoint solve different problems. The decision is not which product wins. The decision is which job each surface performs and which jobs it should not be asked to imitate. The Community Hub architecture should follow those role assignments consistently so users are not forced to guess whether the authoritative answer is in a document library, a meeting chat, a community post, or a bot conversation.

Managed environments and DLP are the sixth dependency. The Community Hub's own workflows, Dataverse tables, connectors, approvals, publishing process, and assistant must live within the same environment strategy and policy framework as the solutions it governs. A Community Hub built in an unmanaged exception environment creates the exact governance gap it is intended to close.

Agent-enabling assets are the seventh dependency. Decision guides, risk matrices, hypothesis templates, agent patterns, starter prompts, publication checklists, responsible-use guidance, and support playbooks are the content from which agent builders learn. If the organization intends to enable Copilot Studio but has none of these assets, creating them is a prerequisite for meaningful community enablement.

Read left to right as a readiness scan

Owner decision: who must decide, such as Center of Excellence Lead, Platform Owner, Enablement Lead, or Executive Sponsor.

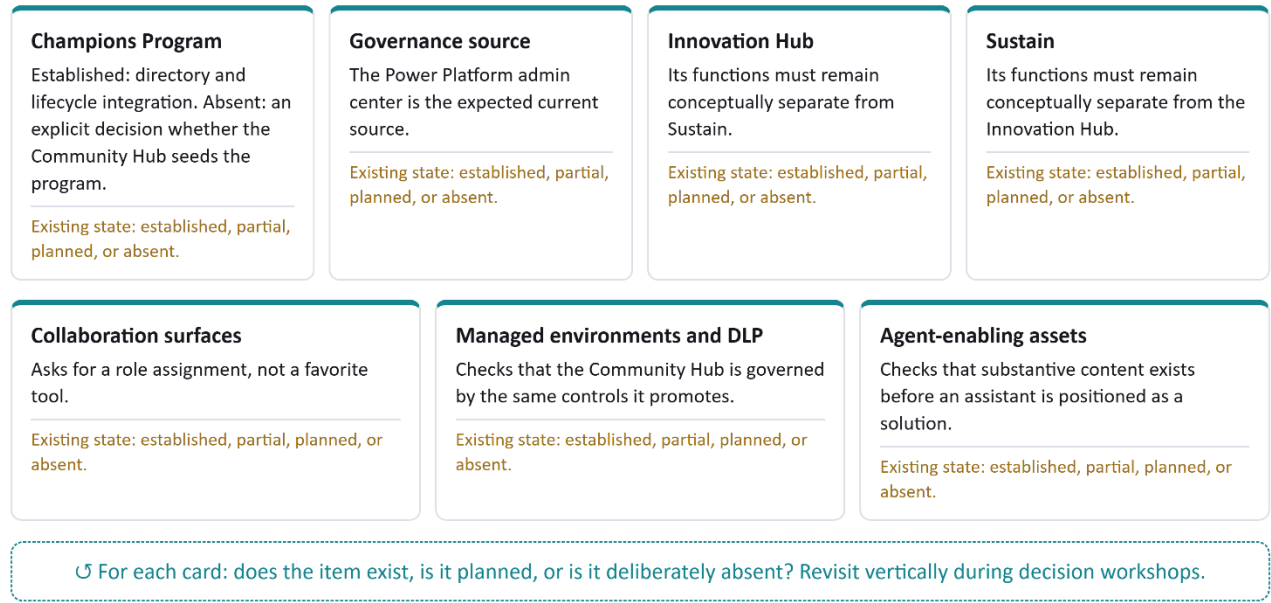


Figure 4. Pre-architecture dependency grid.

SharePoint, Teams, Viva Engage, Copilot Studio, Forms, and Power Pages

SharePoint should serve as the initial central hub for an internal community. A communication site can provide the home page, durable navigation, knowledge articles, FAQs, policy and standards references, training and pattern libraries, announcements, and licensing information. Its value is not visual familiarity alone. Structured, versioned, permissioned content also gives the Hub Assistant a more reliable grounding source than a conversation stream.

Microsoft Teams has two distinct roles. It hosts live interactions such as training sessions and office hours, and it provides a channel in which the Hub Assistant can be published as a bot. Teams should not be treated as the portal. Pinned applications compete for limited visible space, and channel conversations move older content out of immediate view. Embedding the SharePoint Hub in a Teams tab may improve access for some users, but it does not create a second architectural destination.

Viva Engage is the living room of the community. It supports open discussion, organization-wide Q&A, idea sharing, success stories, and event pages with participation mechanisms. This is where community interaction should remain visible beyond a project team or support queue. Using a document library as a discussion space or a Teams channel as a permanent knowledge repository weakens the job each surface is best suited to perform.

Copilot Studio spans two layers. The published channel, whether embedded in SharePoint or exposed in Teams, belongs to the experience layer because it is the interface people use. The orchestration, topics, generative answers, knowledge grounding, and handoff behavior belong to the intelligence layer. Keeping those two aspects separate prevents the visual presence of chat from being mistaken for the entire assistant architecture.

Microsoft Forms has a narrow role in collecting feedback after training, events, and content interactions. It is not a replacement for the Community Hub, request management, or operational data. It is the lightweight capture mechanism behind a specific capability.

Power Pages is a viable later alternative or complement, not the default first front end in this reference pattern. Because requests, onboarding, retirement, assessments, and related operational records live in Dataverse, a Power Pages experience can interact with that data more directly than a SharePoint page. The decision should be reassessed after real usage patterns exist. Starting with SharePoint reduces initial complexity and meets internal users where they already look for content. Moving or extending the front end later becomes a deliberate response to evidence, not an architectural assumption.

Surface	Primary role in the Community Hub	Necessity in this pattern	Design verdict
SharePoint communication site	Central home, navigation, KBAs, FAQs, policy reference, standards, training, patterns, announcements, and licensing information	Necessary anchor	Use as the durable and searchable internal front door and primary governed grounding source.
Microsoft Teams	Live training, office hours, and a bot channel for the Hub Assistant	Necessary for those functions	Do not treat Teams as the portal or permanent knowledge store.
Viva Engage	Open discussion, Q&A, idea sharing, event participation, and success stories	Necessary for Connect and Evolve	Use as the organization-wide community conversation surface.
Copilot Studio published channel	Web chat in SharePoint and bot in Teams	Necessary as the conversational entry point in the experience layer	Separate the visible channel from the orchestration that powers it.

Surface	Primary role in the Community Hub	Necessity in this pattern	Design verdict
Microsoft Forms	Post-event, post-training, and content feedback	Necessary in a narrow scope	Use as a capture tool behind a capability, not as the Community Hub itself.
Power Pages	Dataverse-connected alternative or complementary front end	Viable, evaluate later	Reassess after the internal Community Hub has real usage evidence.

Table 1. Collaboration surfaces and their roles in the Community Hub.

	SharePoint	Teams	Viva Engage	Copilot Studio published channel	Microsoft Forms	Power Pages
Primary job	Durable hub and knowledge	Meetings and bot access	Community conversation and events	Conversational access	Feedback capture	Possible Dataverse-connected front end
Content durability	Structured	Conversational	Conversational	Depends on grounded sources and transcript policy	Transactional capture	Structured
Interaction mode	Browse	Meet	Discuss	Ask	Submit	Transact
Explicit non-role	Not the primary discussion community	Not the front door or knowledge base	Not the policy repository	Not the owner of governance decisions	Not request management	Not an automatic day-one requirement

Division of responsibility, not product competition

SharePoint is the initial anchor; the other products are not subordinate.

Figure 5. Collaboration surface role map.

5. Core capabilities, mapped to the pillars

The Community Hub's information architecture should be organized around four user-facing capability zones called Learn, Govern-aware self-service, Connect, and Evolve. Each zone translates an adoption pillar into concrete actions rather than merely restating the pillar's name.

Learn translates continuous training into a role-sensitive experience. It includes a training catalog, a request-a-session process, certification roadmaps, internal learning trackers, events, office hours, hackathons, reusable patterns, templates, Copilot Studio agent assets, and agent-literacy guidance for end users who consume agents rather than build them. The catalog should distinguish content for end users, makers, citizen developers, owners, champions, administrators, and support personnel. A visitor should be able to understand what is appropriate now and what represents a later maturity step.

Govern-aware self-service translates scalable governance and support into plain-language decisions. It includes KBAs and FAQs, policy summaries, standards references, self-service assessments, a service request catalog, go-live checklists, administrative links, and separate escalation routes for end-user support and maker or citizen-developer support. The phrase govern-aware matters. Self-service should not bypass governance. It should make governance understandable enough that users can take the correct action without waiting for the Center of Excellence to interpret every rule.

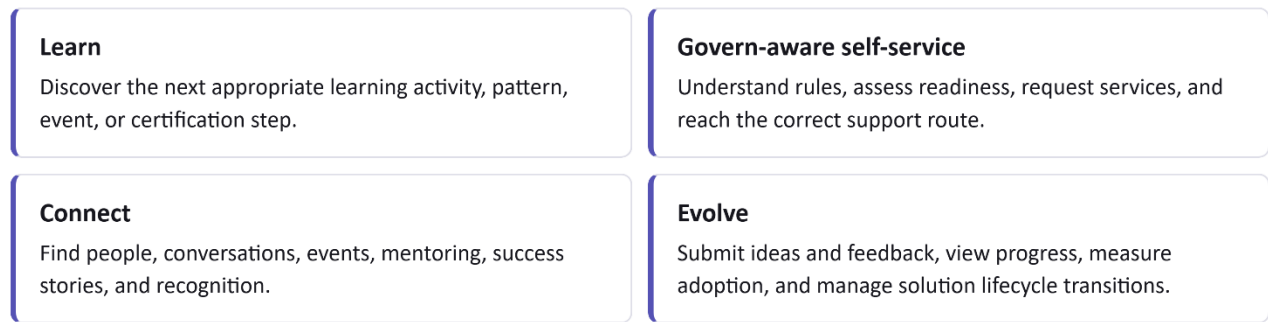


Figure 6. The Community Hub capability zones.

Connect translates active community and engagement into people and participation. It includes a champion directory with expertise tags, nomination and lifecycle workflows, discussion and Q&A, community events, success stories, mentoring pathways, recognition, and an early-visibility briefing that gives champions advance sight of platform and program developments before general announcement. Connect must support both discovery and contribution. A member should be able to find a person or event, but also submit knowledge, answer a question, nominate a peer, or share an outcome.

Evolve translates evolution strategy into visible change. It includes idea intake, feedback on content and events, adoption measures, a visible improvement backlog, a What's New log, and solution onboarding and retirement. These capabilities prevent feedback from disappearing into an inbox and make lifecycle decisions part of normal community operations.

The Hub Assistant is a Copilot Studio agent published inside the Community Hub, and it is the only capability that crosses all four zones. Grounded in governed Community Hub content, it converts search the Community Hub into ask the Community Hub. It can answer routine questions, point to the relevant KBA or policy summary, clarify which request type a person needs, and expose patterns in what the community is asking. It should not make unowned policy decisions or replace deterministic workflows. The assistant is valuable because it reduces friction and generates insight, not because conversation is inherently better than navigation.

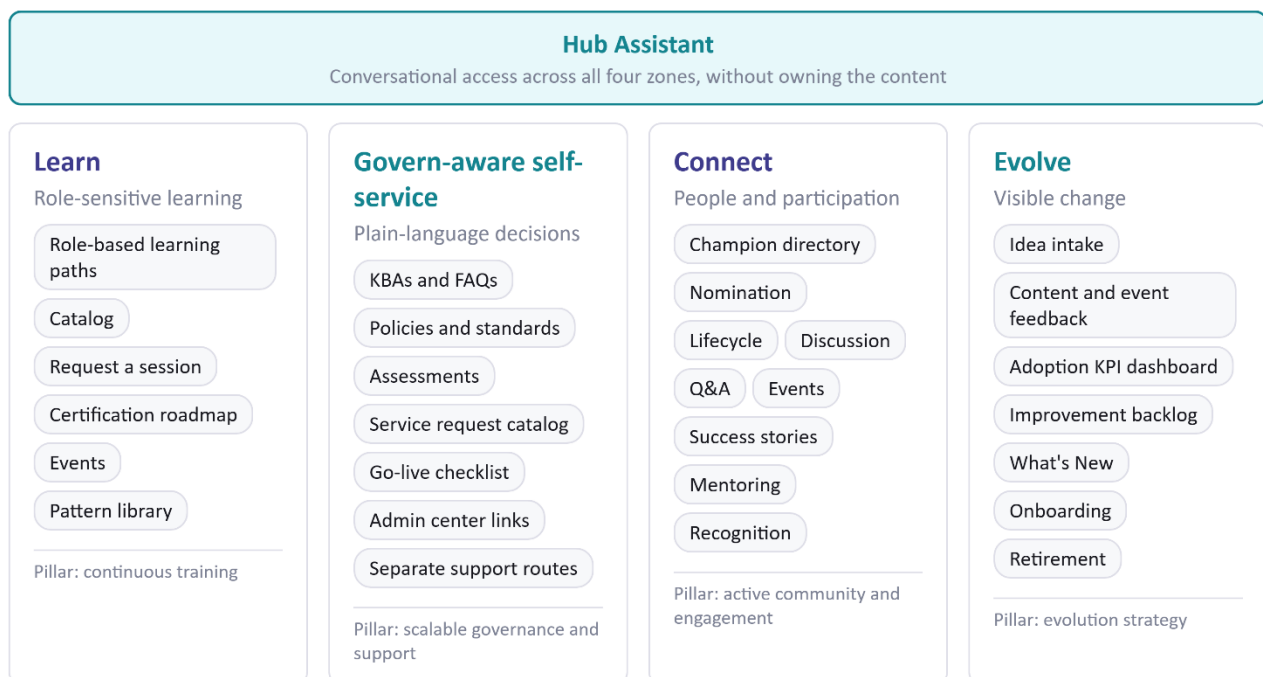


Figure 7. Capability-to-pillar map.

WARNING

Four different needs are often called a request, but they do not share a destination. An idea goes to the Innovation Hub's development responsibility. A training request goes to the Innovation Hub's adoption responsibility. A service request goes to Sustain's platform operations. A maker or citizen-developer support request goes to Sustain's support responsibility, using champions or mentors as the first tier when appropriate. Sending all four through one generic contact form creates hidden triage work, unclear service expectations, and avoidable delay.

6. Core processes to define before launch

A capability becomes trustworthy only when its trigger, owner, route, service expectation, handoff, record, and closure condition are defined. The Community Hub should not launch a form or tile merely because the interface can be built.

Processes that route to the Innovation Hub include idea and feedback intake, training requests, and event registration. The Innovation Hub is the executing arm of the Center of Enablement, which is why requests that are enablement in nature arrive there: the Center of Enablement keeps the supervision, planning, and strategy of training and community development, and the Innovation Hub carries them out. Idea intake begins when any visitor proposes an opportunity or improvement. The Innovation Hub's innovation committee owns triage and evaluation. Every submission requires an acknowledgment, including a transparent not now. Triage should include a check against the existing solution inventory and pattern catalog, so a duplicate idea becomes a reuse conversation rather than a second build. A silent backlog trains the community not to participate.

Training requests begin when the needed session or learning path is not available through self-service. The Center of Enablement owns the learning plan behind them, and the Innovation Hub's adoption responsibility owns fulfillment or scheduling. The request experience should state an expected response time and should capture role, topic, desired outcome, audience, and urgency. A request that disappears creates the impression that the Community Hub does not work even if the training team is active elsewhere.

Event registration begins when a new event is published. The organizer may be the Center of Excellence, a champion, a trainer, or another approved community contributor. Registration needs capacity rules, a waitlist where appropriate, calendar information, accessibility information, attendance handling, and post-event feedback. Without these controls, popular events become first-come chaos and attendance data cannot support improvement.

Processes that route to Sustain include service requests, maker or citizen-developer support, end-user support and escalation, solution onboarding, and solution retirement. A service request can include an environment, migration, backup, access, DLP exception, or sandbox need. Sustain's platform operations owns the queue, and a DLP exception is decided by the governance function, never by the operations team that processes it. It must remain separate from idea and training intake because it carries different authority, risk, data requirements, and service expectations.

Maker or citizen-developer support begins when a builder is stuck with a formula, connector, design pattern, agent topic, or solution behavior. Champions and mentors can provide a peer first tier, with clear escalation to the Center of Excellence or specialist support. Peer help should distribute expertise, not turn a few volunteers into an invisible support team. The process needs boundaries, escalation criteria, and recognition for sustained contribution.

End-user support begins with a question or problem involving a published solution. The first route may be self-service or the Hub Assistant, followed by community help where suitable, then a human ticket with the correct application or support owner. These routes are the tiered support model already defined for Sustain, from L0 self-service upward; the Community Hub gives that model a front door rather than creating a parallel one. The handoff must be explicit. A user should not have to restate the problem after the Community Hub has already collected context.

Solution onboarding begins when an application, flow, report, or agent has passed the required go-live checks. Sustain's application maintenance responsibility owns the operational record, with the solution owner confirmed through the Center of Excellence's governance process. Registration in the inventory matters, but inventory alone is insufficient. Ownership, support, dependencies, criticality, data, environment, and retirement conditions should be known.

Solution retirement begins when an owner departs, usage declines, a scheduled review identifies redundancy, a replacement becomes available, or risk makes continued operation inappropriate. Sustain owns the operational retirement process, with the Center of Excellence confirming owner and policy decisions. Every solution should have a default consequence if no owner responds. Otherwise, ownerless solutions persist indefinitely.

Processes handled within the Community Hub include role-based onboarding, content publishing and review, champion nomination and lifecycle, self-service assessment, recognition, KPI reporting, and governance review of the Community Hub itself. Onboarding should provide a first-five-minutes path for each profile. Content publishing requires a named individual owner, review cadence, status, and expiry rule. Champion lifecycle needs nomination, acceptance, expectations, activity review, and frictionless offboarding. Assessments should end in a concrete next step, not merely a score. Recognition needs a pre-approved non-monetary path so it does not stall in a budget cycle. KPI reporting must use business-value language for sponsors and operational language for operators, and must feed the steering committee's regular review cadence. The Community Hub governance review should test ownership, DLP, environments, content, assistant behavior against its documented scope using a repeatable test set and sampled transcripts, request performance, and retirement criteria.

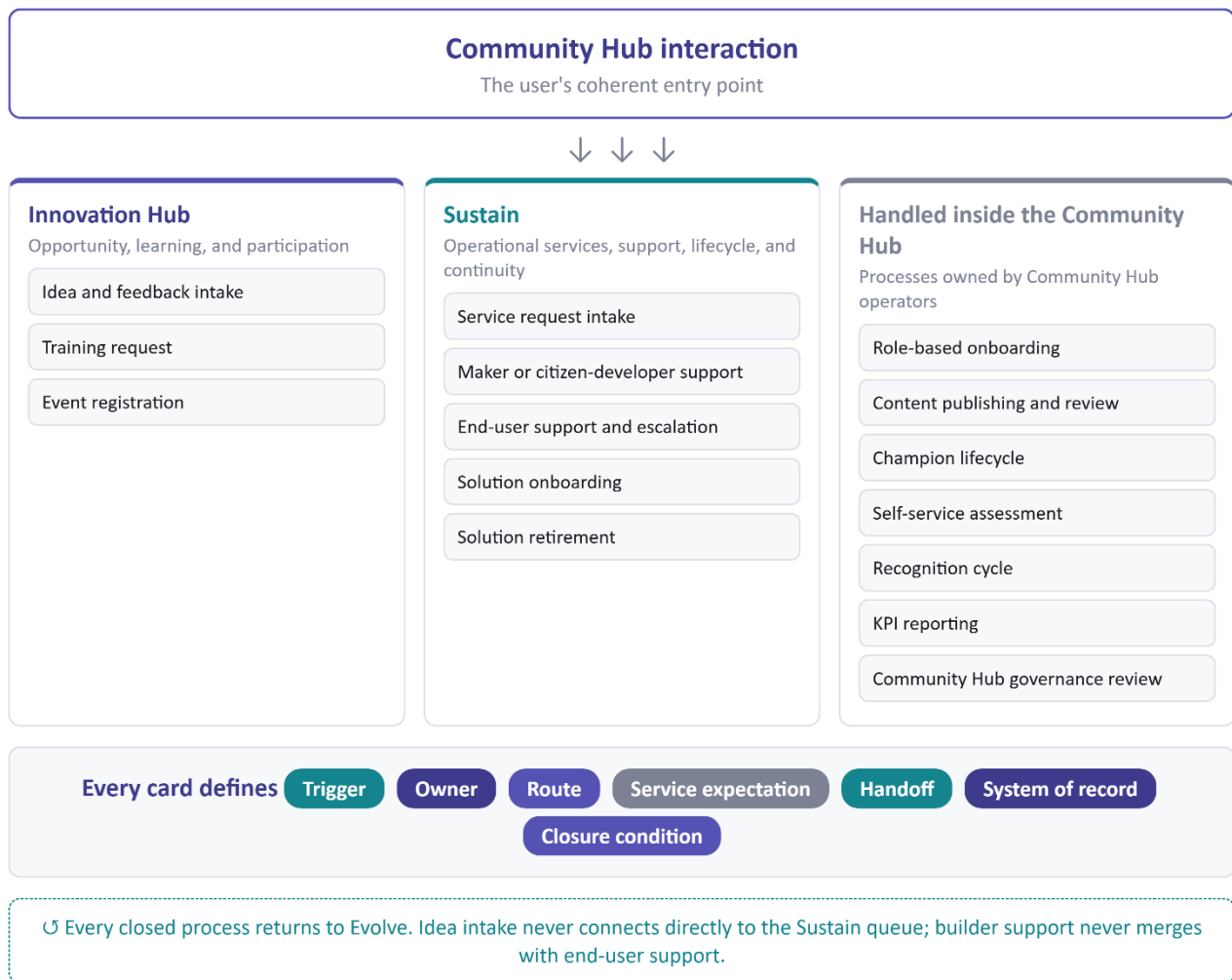


Figure 8. Process routing catalog.

The process catalog is also a control against premature automation. A workflow should not be automated until ownership, decisions, exceptions, and handoffs are understood. Otherwise, automation makes ambiguity move faster. The Hub Assistant can help a user select the right route and prefill known context, while Power Automate can execute deterministic approvals, reminders, notifications, and status changes. Neither should invent policy where the operating model has not made a decision.

7. Functional diagram: what the community experiences

The functional model should show the community one coherent experience while preserving multiple accountable destinations behind it. The front door is unified, but the operating model is not collapsed.

Users enter through surfaces with specific jobs. SharePoint provides the durable home, navigation, knowledge, policies, patterns, training catalog, announcements, and links. Viva Engage provides open community discussion, Q&A, stories, and events. Teams provides live meetings and access to the assistant as a bot. The Copilot Studio published channel provides conversational access within SharePoint and Teams. Microsoft Forms captures focused feedback where a lightweight form is sufficient.

Behind those surfaces, the Community Hub organizes the experience into Learn, Govern-aware self-service, Connect, and Evolve. The Hub Assistant spans all four capability zones by answering from governed content, helping users locate actions, and clarifying request categories. It does not remove the need for visible navigation. Conversation and browsing should reinforce one another so users can verify an answer, open its source, and continue through a deterministic process.

Outgoing work splits between the Innovation Hub and Sustain. Ideas, training requests, adoption activities, community development, and events belong to the Innovation Hub. Platform operations, environment services, access, migrations, backups, DLP exceptions, builder support, end-user support, onboarding, maintenance, and retirement belong to Sustain. The same people may staff both functions in a small Center of Excellence, but the labels remain distinct because they represent different accountabilities.

Governance and measurement form the foundation. Identity, DLP, environment strategy, platform inventory, monitoring, content ownership, request records, and KPIs apply across the entire experience. The foundation is not another destination for requests. It is the set of rules and signals under which every destination operates.

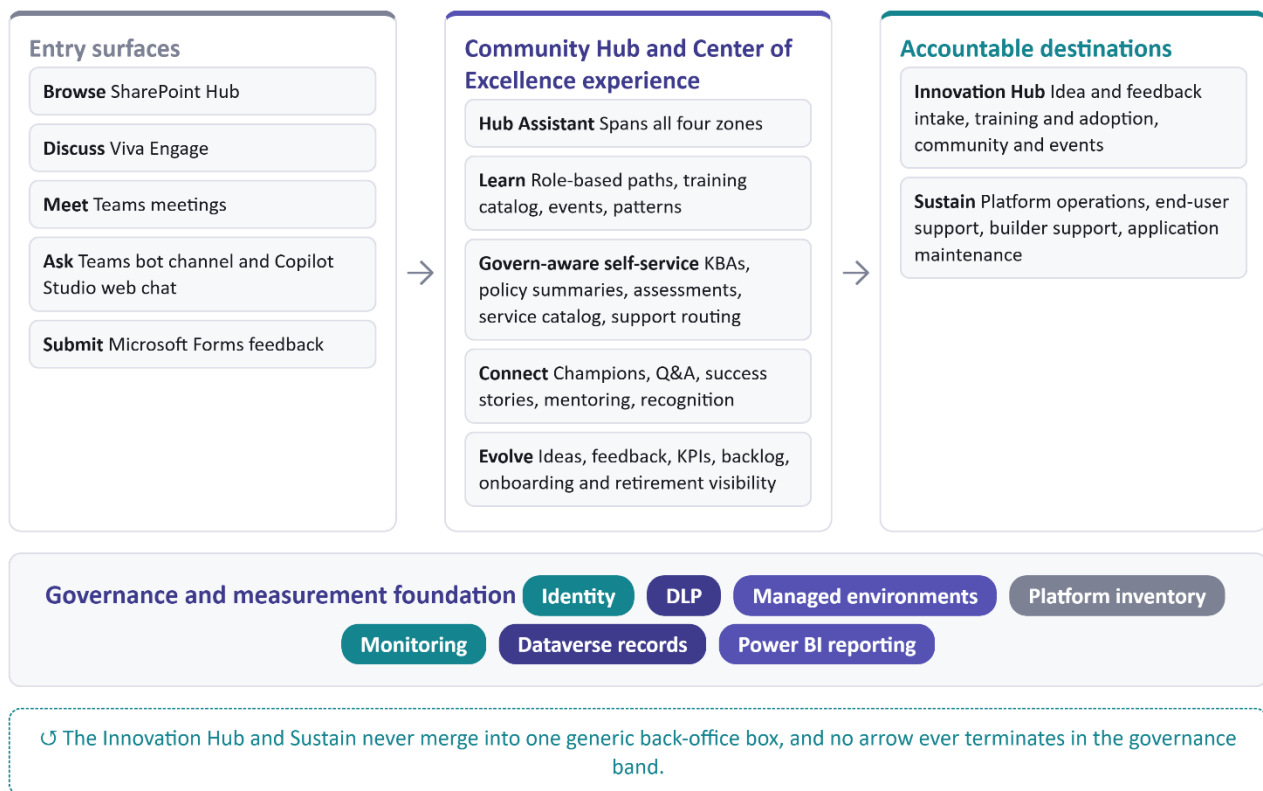


Figure 9. Functional experience and routing model.

The diagram is intended for conversations with champions, business owners, and sponsors. It avoids product-level architecture except where a surface name helps users understand the experience. Its main message is operational: people should encounter one coherent Community Hub, but every request must arrive at a function that can act on it. The technical implementation comes next.

8. Layered technical architecture

The technical architecture should be built from identity and governance upward, not from the visible portal downward. The experience layer is the last expression of decisions made in the layers beneath it.

Layer 1 is identity and environmental control. Entra ID provides identity and role assignment. DLP policies define which connectors and data movements are permitted. Managed environments apply operational and governance controls to the environments in which the Community Hub's Power Platform components run. The Community Hub is itself a solution subject to the organization's control framework. It should not be granted a permanent exception simply because the Center of Excellence owns it.

Identity design should begin with the audience model in Chapter 3. End users need access to public internal content and published interaction surfaces. Makers and citizen developers may need targeted learning, sandbox information, and request capabilities. Champions need community management and contribution paths. Content owners need publishing and review permissions. Operators need access to request and lifecycle records. Administrators need platform-level views. Sponsors need aggregated reporting. These are not necessarily implemented as eight one-to-one security roles, but the permissions must reflect the different jobs.

Layer 2 is governance. The Power Platform admin center is the source of truth for inventory, usage, monitoring, licensing signals, and administrative actions. The Community Hub can surface selected summaries or contextual links, but should not duplicate the entire administrative experience. The boundary is deliberate. The Community Hub helps people understand and act on governance. The admin center remains the authoritative administrative service.

Layer 3 is data. Dataverse stores structured records for champions, expertise tags, nominations, lifecycle status, resources, events, registrations, requests, assessments, acknowledgments, feedback, ownership, solution onboarding, solution retirement, review dates, and selected KPI inputs. Relational integrity matters because these are not independent lists. A champion belongs to a lifecycle. An event has an organizer and registrations. A solution has an owner and review history. A request has a category, requester, accountable team, status, and outcome. A content item has an owner and review date.

Dataverse also supports row-level security and application lifecycle management through solutions. Those capabilities allow the Community Hub to distinguish community-visible information from operator-only records and to move controlled components across environments. The data model should remain focused on Community Hub operations. It should not become a shadow inventory for every administrative object already maintained elsewhere.

Layer 4 is intelligence and automation. Copilot Studio provides the orchestration behind the Hub Assistant, including topics, generative answers, knowledge grounding, conversation paths, and escalation behavior. The assistant should use the Community Hub's governed content and expose its sources in every channel where it is published; the instruction to verify an answer only works when the source is visible. Its scope

should be explicit, and it should carry the risk classification and governance zone that its organization-wide reach implies, with controls following that classification. Its transcript policy should be equally explicit: users should be told that conversations are retained and reviewed in aggregate to improve content, routing, and grounding, not to evaluate individuals. It may explain a policy summary, locate a pattern, identify a training path, distinguish request types, and collect initial context. It should not approve exceptions, reinterpret policy, or claim ownership of a decision.

Power Automate handles deterministic workflow. Examples include sending acknowledgments, requesting approvals, reminding content owners before review dates, notifying request owners, creating records, updating status, escalating breached service targets, and distributing recognition notices. These steps have known inputs, conditions, and outcomes. They should not be delegated to a conversational agent merely because the agent is visible to the user.

Layer 5 is experience. The SharePoint communication site is the central Community Hub. Teams provides meetings and a bot channel. Viva Engage provides community conversation and event engagement. The Copilot Studio published channel provides the assistant's web chat and Teams presence. Microsoft Forms supports limited feedback capture. Power Pages remains a deferred alternative or complement where direct Dataverse interaction and transactional experience later justify it.

Power BI is cross-cutting. It transforms selected admin center and Dataverse signals into operational and business-value reporting. Operational views may show request volume, routing accuracy, aging, service performance, unanswered questions, content review status, event registration, attendance, feedback, and assistant topic patterns. Sponsor views should summarize adoption, value, risk, capability development, and improvement outcomes. The same underlying signals can serve both audiences, but the narrative and level of detail should differ.

External systems are integrations, not layers of the Community Hub. An ITSM platform may own escalated tickets. A dedicated survey platform may replace Forms. A project or portfolio system may manage the Innovation Hub backlog. Monitoring services may feed platform operations. A learning management system may own formal curricula. The architecture should show where a process crosses a boundary, but it should not list every surrounding system as if the Community Hub owns it.

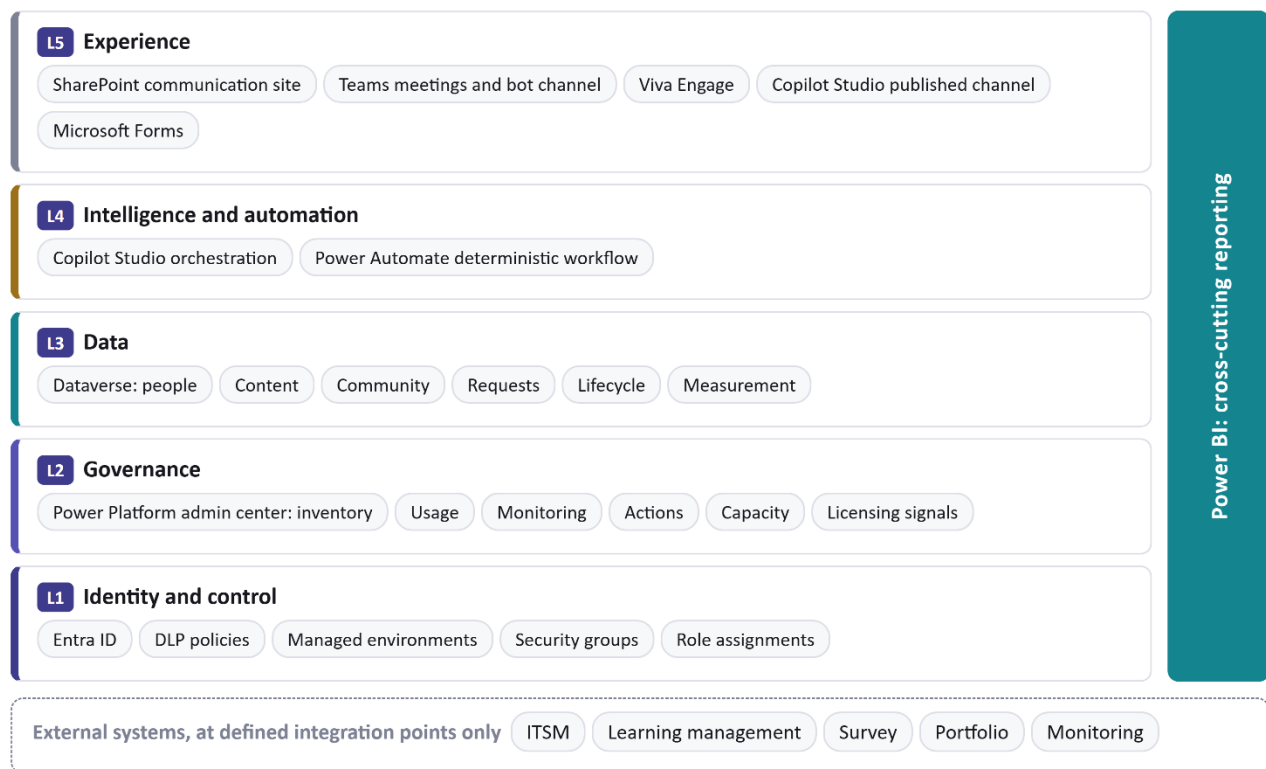


Figure 10. Layered technical architecture.

Why each tool is present

Layer	Tool or service	Architectural justification
L5 Experience	SharePoint communication site	Provides the durable home, navigation, KBAs, policy references, training and pattern catalog, announcements, and primary governed knowledge source.
L5 Experience	Teams meetings and bot channel	Hosts synchronous training and office hours and makes the Hub Assistant available where many users already collaborate. It is not the portal or knowledge store.
L5 Experience	Viva Engage	Provides open discussion, organic Q&A, success stories, community-scale participation, and event engagement.

Layer	Tool or service	Architectural justification
L5 Experience	Copilot Studio published channel	Presents the assistant as embedded web chat in SharePoint and as a bot in Teams.
L5 Experience	Microsoft Forms	Captures lightweight feedback after training, events, or content interactions when a dedicated process application is unnecessary.
L4 Intelligence	Copilot Studio orchestration	Manages grounded answers, topics, conversation behavior, clarification, and handoff while remaining constrained by governed knowledge and explicit policy.
L4 Intelligence	Power Automate	Executes approvals, reminders, notifications, record updates, escalations, and other deterministic workflow steps.
L3 Data	Dataverse	Maintains relational integrity, role-sensitive records, and application lifecycle management for Community Hub operational data.
L2 Governance	Power Platform admin center	Supplies authoritative platform inventory, usage, monitoring, administrative action, capacity, and licensing signals.
L1 Identity and Control	Entra ID, DLP, and managed environments	Applies identity, access, connector, data movement, and environment controls to the Community Hub itself.
Cross-cutting	Power BI	Converts governance and operational signals into audience-appropriate reporting for operators and sponsors.

Table 2. Architectural justification for each tool in the Community Hub's stack.

RISK

A bespoke external website, a second identity system, or a parallel ticketing service may be valid under specific constraints, such as a public community whose members do not have Entra identities. None should be a silent default for an internal Community Hub. Each additional surface increases integration, support, security, content, and governance responsibilities. NOTE

This is the Community Hub's stack, not the Center of Excellence's entire toolchain. Supporting platforms remain outside the architecture unless they participate in a defined Community Hub interaction or handoff. The boundary keeps the model readable and prevents an architecture diagram from turning into an application inventory.

9. Mockups

The first mockups should validate information architecture and routing, not establish a final visual identity. Their purpose is to test whether users can recognize where they are, understand what they can do, and choose the right next action.

The home frame uses the SharePoint Hub as the visible anchor. It begins with a short welcome message and a concise summary of what changed this week. Beneath the welcome, a visible role selector opens the role-selectable landing paths described in Chapter 3, so the home frame orients each profile without forcing everyone through the same generic tour. Beneath it, four equal cards represent Learn, Govern-aware self-service, Connect, and Evolve. Each card contains a role-neutral description and one current signal, such as a newly published pattern, an updated policy summary, an upcoming event, or the number of improvement items in review. The home frame should not attempt to display every feature. It should orient the visitor and expose the four capability zones.

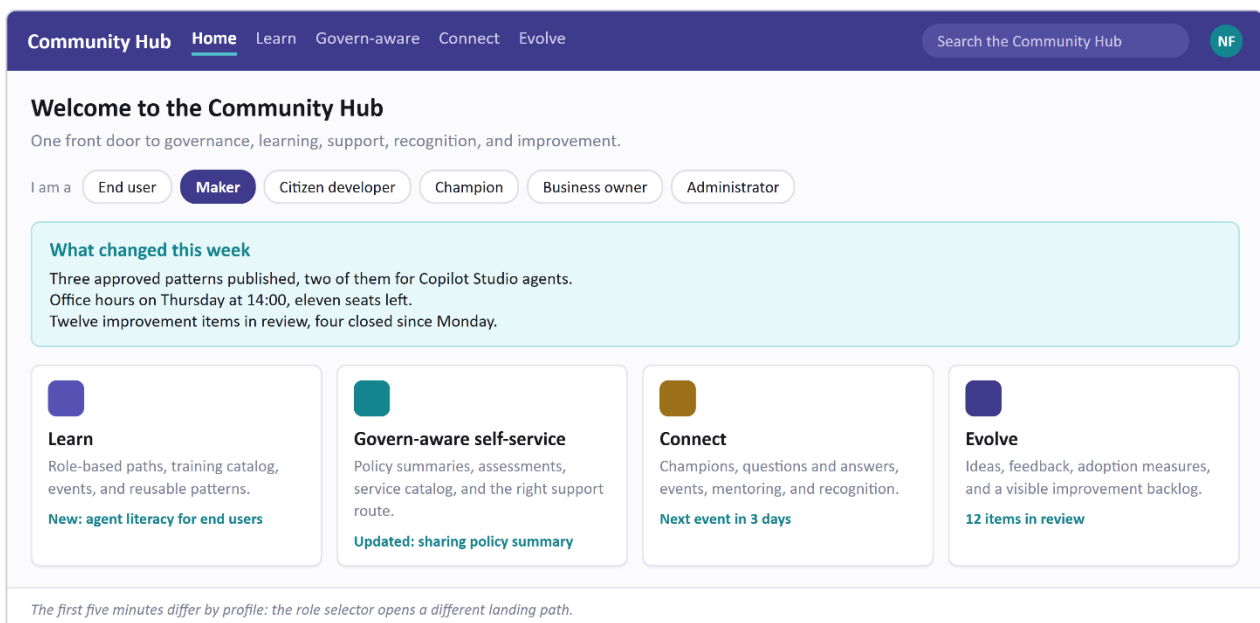


Figure 11. The Community Hub home page.

The request-routing frame replaces a generic contact form. Its heading asks, What do you need? Five action cards distinguish Ask a Question, Share an Idea, Request Training, Request a Service, and Get Build Support. Each card uses plain language, gives an example, and names or implies the destination. Ask a Question points first to the Hub Assistant and governed knowledge. Share an Idea routes to the Innovation Hub's idea intake. Request Training routes to the Innovation Hub's adoption responsibility. Request a Service routes to Sustain's platform operations. Get Build Support routes to the builder-support path with champion or mentor participation before specialist escalation where appropriate.

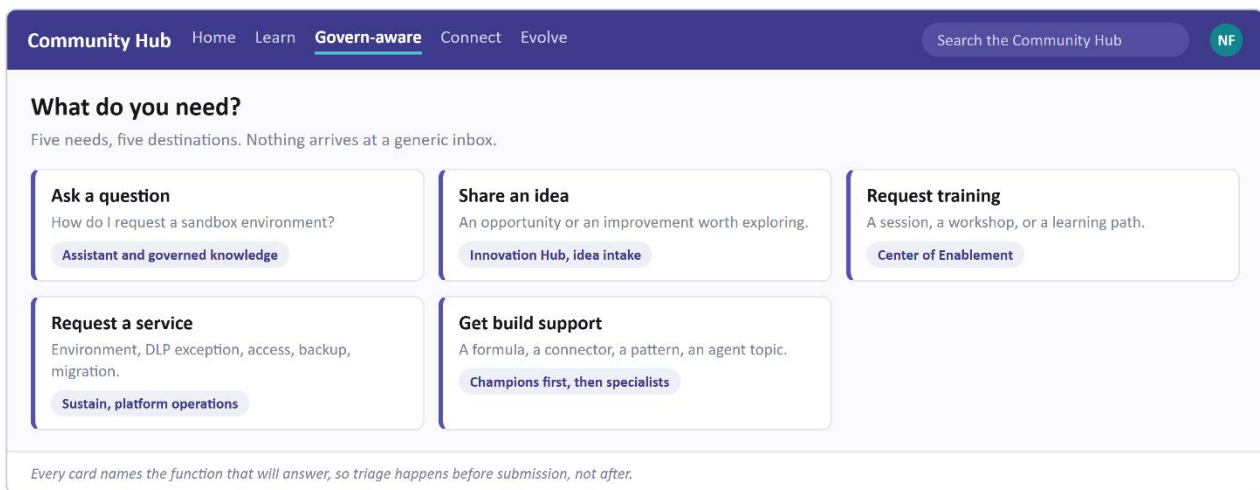


Figure 12. The Get help page and its five routes.

The champion-directory frame makes community expertise visible. Each card shows a person's name, expertise tags, organizational area where appropriate, availability or contact expectations, and recognition status. The directory should include filters for topic, technology, language, region, and type of support if those dimensions are relevant to the organization. A Nominate a Champion action is visible, but nomination does not grant the role automatically. The underlying lifecycle process still requires review, acceptance, and ownership.

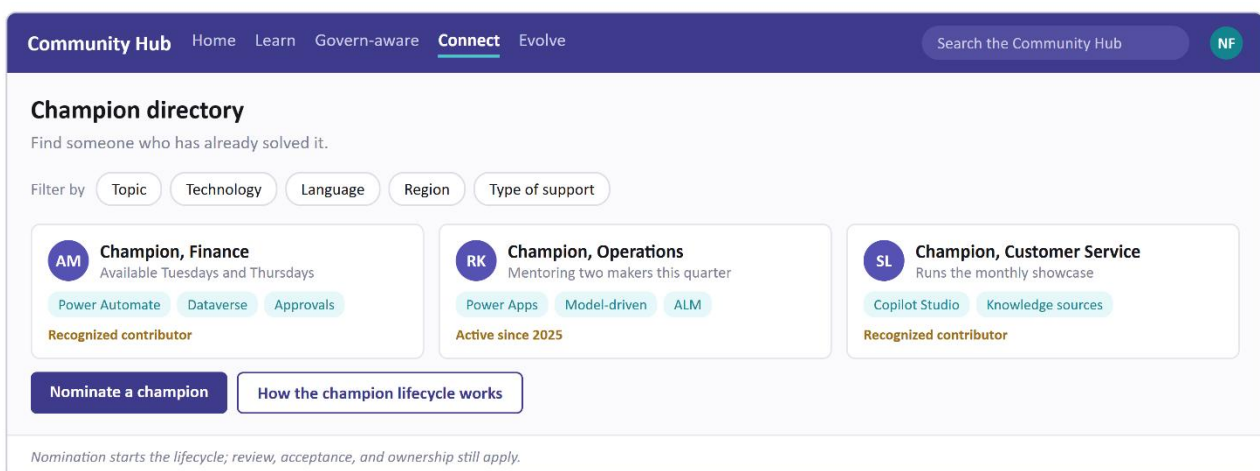


Figure 13. The champion directory.

The Hub Assistant frame demonstrates grounded conversation. A suggested prompt asks about the go-live checklist for a Copilot Studio agent. The response points to the current governed checklist, summarizes key requirements, shows the content owner and review date retrieved through a deterministic topic step from the Dataverse content record rather than from generative grounding alone, and offers a deterministic next action such as start onboarding, open the policy page, or report an inaccurate answer to the content owner. A persistent note explains that answers should be verified against linked sources and that approval decisions remain with accountable humans.

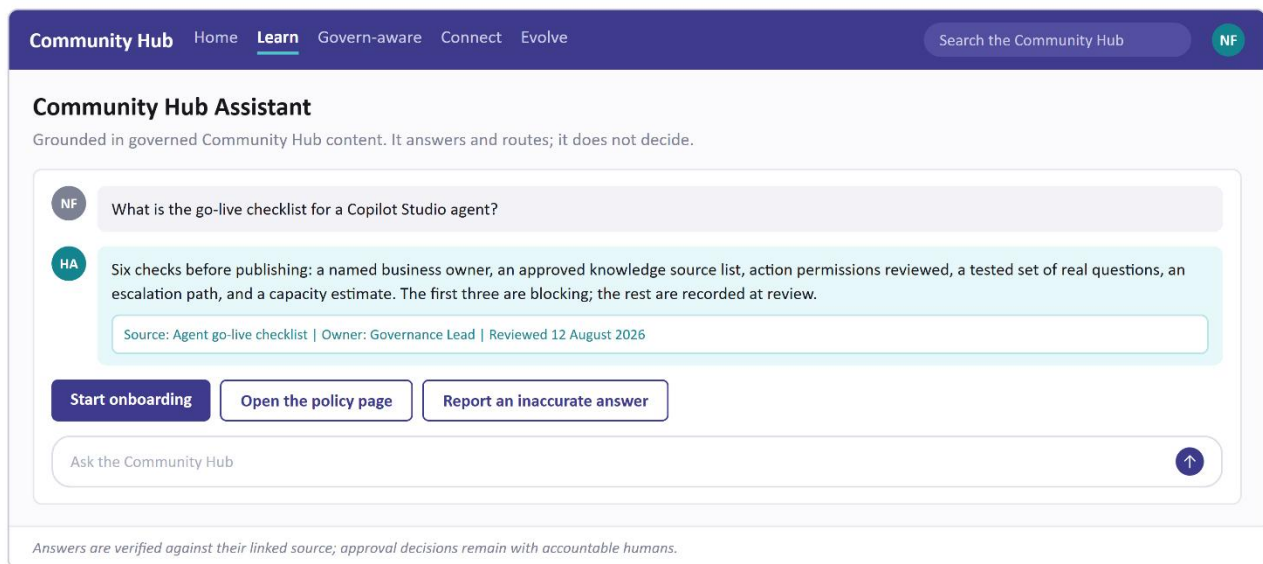


Figure 14. The Community Hub Assistant in conversation.

The mockups should be tested with representative profiles from Chapter 3. An end user should be able to find usage help without encountering maker-specific complexity. A maker should locate a pattern and understand when build support is appropriate. A champion should recognize the community and contribution pathways. A business owner should find ownership and lifecycle guidance. An operator should see how the visible cards connect to governed processes. If a participant must already understand the Center of Excellence's internal structure to choose correctly, the information architecture is not finished.

10. Licensing by role: entitlements, not prices

Licensing should be described as the entitlements required by each role and capability, not as a static price list. Commercial names, packaging, and availability change, while the underlying need for seeded use, premium creation, capacity, administration, automation, reporting, and agent consumption remains.

The end user or consumer typically relies on Microsoft 365 seeded rights for simple Power Apps and Power Automate use and on included access to Teams and Viva Engage. Interaction with a Copilot Studio agent published in Teams draws from tenant-level Copilot Studio capacity, not from a personal Copilot Studio license assigned to every user. The design consequence is that community use of the assistant still creates a capacity obligation even when individual end users do not purchase a builder license. The same discipline applies to the Dataverse-backed intake described in Chapter 8. A Power Apps experience over Dataverse is premium for every user who opens it, so request, registration, assessment, and feedback capture for this profile must reach Dataverse through channels whose entitlement is carried elsewhere, such as the Hub Assistant or Process-licensed automation, or the seeded-rights assumption for end users no longer holds.

The maker requires Power Apps Premium when the solution uses Dataverse or premium connectors. Simple, low-complexity applications may remain within seeded rights where supported. The Community Hub should not encourage a premium architecture for a task that does not need one, but it should also avoid teaching makers to design around licensing limits at the expense of governance, data integrity, or maintainability.

The citizen developer is more likely to require Power Apps Premium, Power Automate Premium, a suitable development or sandbox entitlement, access to Dataverse capacity as usage grows, and Copilot Studio builder rights where this profile builds agents rather than only using them. A legacy per-app purchasing path is not a safe default for new designs outside the conditions in which it remains available. The durable design principle is to validate the current offer and channel rather than preserve a SKU name in architecture.

The champion does not receive a separate license tier merely because the program assigns champion status. Entitlements follow the actual work performed. A champion who uses existing solutions needs consumer rights. A champion who builds solutions needs maker or citizen-developer rights. Early access, recognition, and community status are governance and program decisions.

The business or agent owner begins with the entitlements required to use the solution. If that person owns an agent, tenant-level agent consumption must be budgeted. If that person views protected Power BI content outside a broadly available capacity-backed experience, Power BI Pro or Premium Per User may be required according to the implemented sharing model. Ownership is primarily an accountability role, but the work performed by the owner determines licensing.

The platform administrator receives administrative access through role assignment in Entra ID rather than a purchasable admin-center SKU. Separate reporting entitlements may be needed where the implementation

uses Power BI Pro or Premium Per User. Administrative privilege must remain least-privilege and should not be confused with broad Community Hub operator access.

The Center of Excellence or support team needs the entitlements behind the Community Hub's operational services. These may include Dataverse database, file, and log capacity; Power Automate Premium per user or Power Automate Process per flow for workflows; Power BI Pro or Premium Per User for reporting; a share of tenant Copilot Studio capacity; and the appropriate Copilot Studio builder entitlement for the people who create and maintain the Hub Assistant. Exact packaging must be confirmed at implementation time. If the Phase 8 reassessment later activates Power Pages, an additional entitlement category arrives with it: authenticated and anonymous user capacity for the site itself, which belongs to the same budgeting discipline as agent consumption.

Role	Entitlement categories	Design note
End user or consumer	Microsoft 365 seeded use where applicable; Teams and Viva Engage access; tenant-funded agent consumption	Do not assign a Copilot Studio builder license merely to chat with the published Hub Assistant.
Maker	Seeded rights for eligible simple solutions; Power Apps Premium when Dataverse or premium connectors are used	Escalating complexity may require the citizen-developer path.
Citizen developer	Power Apps Premium, Power Automate Premium where applicable, suitable development access, capacity as usage grows, and Copilot Studio builder rights where agents are built	Validate current offer names and purchasing conditions during implementation.
Champion	Entitlements associated with the person's consumer, maker, or citizen-developer work	Champion status is a program role, not a commercial SKU.
Business or agent owner	Consumer entitlements plus reporting access and tenant-funded agent consumption where applicable	Accountability comes first; licenses follow actual activities.
Platform administrator	Entra administrative role assignment and reporting entitlements if required	Admin center access is role-based rather than a separate purchasable SKU.

Role	Entitlement categories	Design note
Center of Excellence or support team	Dataverse capacity, automation entitlements, reporting entitlements, Copilot Studio capacity, and builder rights	Budget shared service capacity explicitly and assign operational ownership.

Table 3. Entitlement categories by role.

Role	Seeded use	Premium app creation	Premium automation	Dataverse capacity	Reporting	Copilot Studio capacity or builder rights
End user or consumer	Required	Not applicable	Not applicable	Not applicable	Conditional	Tenant-funded
Maker	Conditional	Conditional	Conditional	Conditional	—	—
Citizen developer	—	Required	Conditional	Tenant-funded	Conditional	Conditional
Champion	Inherits the markers of the person's underlying role	—	—	—	—	—
Business or agent owner	Required	—	—	—	Conditional	Tenant-funded when the owned solution includes an agent
Platform administrator	—	—	—	—	Conditional	—
Center of Excellence or support team	—	Conditional	Required	Tenant-funded	Required	Required

Legend

An individual license is distinct from shared tenant capacity. Platform administration is role-based in Entra ID, not a purchasable SKU. No single Community Hub license exists; exact commercial names must be validated at implementation time.

Required

Conditional

Tenant-funded

Not applicable

Figure 15. Licensing and entitlement matrix.

WARNING

The Hub Assistant is a Copilot Studio agent and consumes tenant capacity. Estimate message or session demand before launch, assign an owner for the consumption line, monitor actual demand, and reassess after the first month of real traffic. Do not classify it as free because no individual user owns the bill.

Product naming and offer conditions here are current to August 2026, including Power Automate Premium, Power Automate Process, Copilot Credits sold through Message Pack or Pay-As-You-Go mechanisms, the move away from Power BI Premium P-SKUs for new purchases, and conditions affecting Power Apps per-app availability. These statements are useful for the decision model, but final implementation must confirm the current Microsoft Product Terms, licensing guides, admin experiences, and purchasing channel.

11. Implementation journey

The target architecture should be implemented through evidence-based increments. Ownership and governance come first, a useful anchor comes second, and automation or conversational intelligence arrives only after the Community Hub has reliable content and routes.

Phase 1 establishes the baseline. The Center of Excellence inventories makers, citizen developers, champions, solutions, policies, environments, support paths, learning assets, and existing communities. It confirms the Power Platform admin center as the governance source described in this model. The exit condition is not a completed inventory alone. A named owner must exist for the Community Hub, governance, the Innovation Hub, and Sustain as distinct functions, even if one person temporarily holds several responsibilities. Naming that owner is also where the Chapter 4 decision closes: either the Innovation Hub exists as an accountability, or its routes launch as explicitly pending and are labeled as such in the Community Hub.

Phase 2 creates the anchor. The team establishes the SharePoint communication site, durable navigation, initial KBAs or FAQs, policy references, and a small pattern library. It does not launch empty pages for every future capability. The exit condition is a findable URL, a clear owner, and at least one real piece of governed content that solves a current community need.

Phase 3 connects the conversation. The team establishes Viva Engage for discussion and Q&A, publishes an event with a participation mechanism, and begins a Teams cadence for office hours or training. Teams remains a meeting and assistant-access surface, not the destination. The exit condition is one completed event and at least one piece of community-sourced content, such as a question, answer, improvement, or success story.

Phase 4 implements one routing pair. The Center of Excellence chooses one request type with a visible consequence, such as idea intake paired with one Sustain service request. It builds the appropriate Dataverse tables, intake forms, acknowledgments, ownership, status model, service expectation, and routing. The exit condition is at least one real submission processed end to end with an unambiguous accountable owner.

Phase 5 adds the Hub Assistant. The assistant is grounded in the KBAs, FAQs, patterns, and policy summaries that exist at that point. Its initial scope is deliberately narrow: answer from published content, identify the correct route, collect context, and hand off. The exit condition is publication in at least one channel, a documented knowledge scope, an escalation path, evidence from a pre-publication test set that grounded answers are accurate against their sources, a named operational owner accountable for the assistant's behavior and knowledge scope, and an initial capacity estimate.

Phase 6 expands capabilities. Learn, Govern-aware self-service, Connect, and Evolve are developed incrementally based on demand and strategic importance. At least one high-priority capability in every zone

becomes operational, while lower-priority capabilities remain in a visible and dated backlog. The exit condition is transparency. Nothing should be silently absent while the Community Hub appears complete.

Phase 7 operates the model. Recurring processes begin their actual cycles, including recognition, content review, KPI reporting, assistant review, request performance review, and Community Hub governance review. The exit condition is evidence that each recurring process has completed on its defined schedule. Documentation of a process is not the same as operation.

Phase 8 reassesses scope. The Center of Excellence revisits deferred choices, including whether Power Pages should replace or complement SharePoint, whether Innovation Hub and Sustain still function effectively with shared staff, whether support should integrate with a formal ITSM service, whether agent scope should expand, and whether licensing assumptions remain current. The exit condition is a recorded yes, no, or not-yet decision for each deferred item.

Phase	Indicative focus	Exit condition
1. Baseline	Inventory people, solutions, governance, content, and support; name accountable functions	Named owners exist for the Community Hub, governance, Innovation Hub, and Sustain.
2. Anchor	Launch the SharePoint Hub with real knowledge and policy content	A findable home contains at least one useful governed asset.
3. Connect the talk	Establish community discussion, events, office hours, and training cadence	A real event occurs and generates community participation or content.
4. Pick one routing pair	Implement one Innovation Hub route and one Sustain route	Real submissions are triaged end to end with owners and service expectations.
5. Add the assistant	Publish a narrowly grounded Hub Assistant	One channel is live, scope, owner, and handoff are documented, grounded answers pass a test set, and capacity is estimated.
6. Expand capabilities	Add high-priority capabilities across all four zones	Every zone has a live capability and a visible dated backlog.
7. Operate	Run reviews, recognition, reporting, content governance, and request management	Every recurring process completes one real cycle.

Phase	Indicative focus	Exit condition
8. Reassess scope	Revisit deferred architecture, operating, agent, and licensing decisions	Every deferred choice has an explicit yes, no, or not-yet decision.

Table 4. The eight implementation phases and their exit conditions.

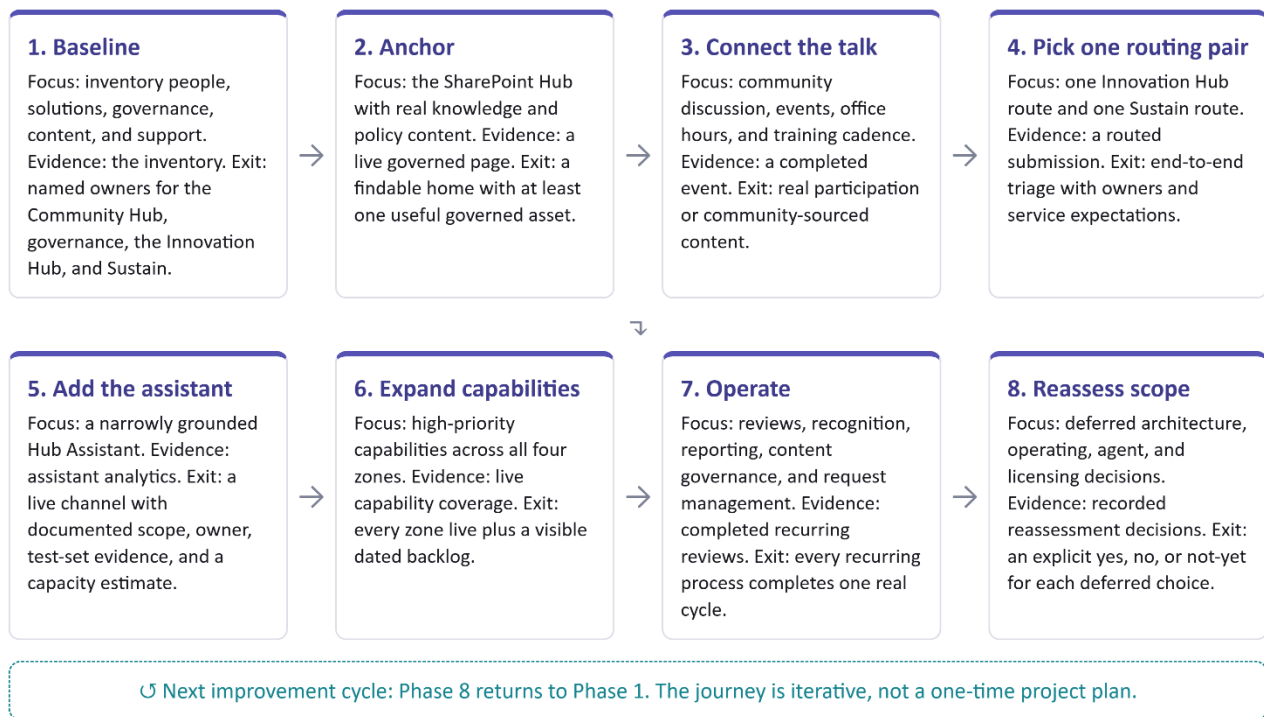


Figure 16. Incremental implementation journey.

NOTE

Start where the consequence is clear. The best first route is not necessarily the most sophisticated. It is a request whose owner is obvious and whose failure has an understandable business consequence. A visible early win gives the Community Hub credibility and gives the assistant reliable material long before the complete target state is available.

12. What this design does not solve

A defensible reference design is defined by its limits. The Community Hub cannot compensate for absent governance, create community participation by decree, remove every licensing change, or replace tenant-specific judgment.

The first residual risk is a Community Hub with no effective Center of Excellence behind it. The Community Hub is a front door and routing layer. It has no authority of its own. If governance, the Innovation Hub, and Sustain do not exist as accountabilities, a well-designed form simply delivers work to nowhere. The compensating direction is to treat the audience, pillar, capability, and process decisions in Chapters 1 through 6 as prerequisites for the architecture.

The second risk is the collapse of Innovation Hub and Sustain into one under-resourced team. Shared staffing may be necessary and reasonable, especially in a smaller organization. The risk arises when responsibility for building the new thing quietly merges with responsibility for keeping the existing thing operational. The compensating direction is to preserve distinct labels, queues, service expectations, and reporting even when people overlap.

The third risk is an unbudgeted Hub Assistant. Agent consumption begins when people use the published assistant. Because the capacity cost may not appear under one person's name, it can be overlooked. The compensating direction is a demand estimate before launch, named ownership, monitoring, and a reassessment using actual first-month traffic.

The fourth risk is stale content. KBAs, FAQs, policy summaries, patterns, learning paths, licensing notes, and assistant grounding sources are living assets. Publication does not keep them accurate. The compensating direction is a named owner, status, effective date, review date, replacement or retirement path, and reporting on overdue reviews.

The fifth risk is promised recognition that cannot be delivered. A Champions Program that announces rewards but has no approved mechanism loses trust. The compensating direction is to approve a sustainable non-monetary recognition path before launching the cycle and to avoid promises dependent on unallocated discretionary spending.

The sixth risk is licensing and SKU drift. Commercial names and offer conditions change. A table that is accurate during design may be wrong during implementation. The compensating direction is to treat Chapter 10 as a model of entitlement categories and to verify names, terms, and channels against current Microsoft sources at the point of purchase and deployment.

The seventh risk is false universality. This reference design does not know the tenant's actual environment strategy, identity model, geographic requirements, security constraints, existing support systems, organizational politics, languages, accessibility requirements, or risk appetite. The compensating direction is to use the design as a starting gate. Every capability, route, control, integration, and licensing assumption must be validated against the real operating context.

Residual risk	Failure mechanism	Compensating direction	Severity	Owner
A Community Hub with no Center of Excellence behind it	The Community Hub can expose and route work but cannot create authority or capacity	Confirm governance, Innovation Hub, Sustain, and ownership before scaling the experience	—	—
Innovation Hub and Sustain collapse	Shared staff can blur build and run accountability	Preserve distinct responsibilities, queues, measures, and escalation even with overlapping people	—	—
The Hub Assistant is not budgeted	Tenant consumption is easy to overlook	Estimate, assign, monitor, and reassess capacity	—	—
Content becomes stale	Publishing does not create ongoing ownership	Assign owners, dates, review cadence, status, and retirement rules	—	—
Recognition is promised but not delivered	Programs can depend on unavailable budgets	Pre-approve a sustainable non-monetary pathway	—	—
Licensing and SKU names drift	Commercial packaging changes faster than operating needs	Validate current terms at implementation and preserve entitlement logic	—	—
The design does not know the tenant	A generic model cannot encode local constraints	Treat every element as a decision to validate, not a template to copy blindly	—	—

Completed by the implementing organization

Severity: High, Medium, or Context-dependent. Owner: Center of Excellence Lead, Platform Owner, Enablement Lead, Content Owner, Commercial Owner, or Executive Sponsor. Compensating direction reduces exposure; the residual risk does not disappear.

Figure 17. Residual-risk matrix.

SPOTLIGHT

The claim is not that this is the correct Community Hub design for every Power Platform Center of Excellence. The claim is that the four-pillar adoption model, the Innovation Hub and Sustain split, and the routing and architecture described here form one plausible and internally consistent way to build an internal community surface.

13. Checklist: things obviousness tends to hide

The final readiness check should focus on decisions that appear obvious until they are absent in production. A Community Hub is ready when ownership, community operations, architecture, licensing, and measurement can withstand routine change.

Ownership and governance

- Every content item has one named individual owner rather than a collective label such as the Center of Excellence.
- Every item has a status, effective date, review date, and retirement or replacement rule.
- The Community Hub has its own governance review cadence and retirement criterion.
- DLP policies explicitly cover the connectors used by Community Hub automations and the Hub Assistant.
- Environment placement, solution transport, connection ownership, and service accounts follow the organization's application lifecycle standards.
- Champion nomination, role acceptance, inactivity review, and offboarding are defined.
- Innovation Hub and Sustain remain distinct accountabilities even when the same people contribute to both.

Community and recognition

- The Champions Program has a named owner and a clear purpose.
- Recognition has a pre-approved non-monetary route that does not depend on ad hoc budget approval.
- Every idea receives acknowledgment, including a transparent not-now outcome.
- Community moderation expectations and escalation routes are visible.
- Content distinguishes what an agent can do from what it cannot do, not only how to configure it.
- Onboarding provides a first-five-minutes path for each principal profile.
- Idea and training routes lead to the Innovation Hub; service requests, builder support, end-user support, onboarding, and retirement lead to Sustain.
- Peer support includes boundaries so champions do not become an unrecognized help desk.

Architecture and licensing

- Governance signals come from the Power Platform admin center rather than an obsolete Starter Kit pattern.
- SharePoint, Teams, Viva Engage, Copilot Studio, Forms, and Power Pages have explicit and non-overlapping roles.
- Dataverse is used for structured Community Hub operational records and does not duplicate authoritative administrative inventory.
- Copilot Studio orchestration and Power Automate deterministic workflow are separated.
- The Hub Assistant's consumption is estimated, budgeted, owned, monitored, and reviewed.
- Premium app and automation entitlements are selected according to actual design, connectors, data, and sharing, not applied indiscriminately.
- Product names and purchasing conditions are revalidated at implementation time.
- Internal-only scope is an explicit decision. Any external-audience requirement triggers a separate identity, security, privacy, and front-end assessment.
- External systems are connected through defined handoffs rather than reproduced inside the Community Hub without justification.

Measurement and improvement

- KPIs use business-value language for sponsors and operational detail for the Center of Excellence.
- Goals and baselines are defined before success is measured.
- Feedback enters a visible backlog with status and ownership.
- Search, assistant, request, event, and content signals are reviewed for recurring friction.
- Training is measured through subsequent behavior, such as pattern reuse and governed solutions built by trained makers, not through attendance or completion alone.
- Routing accuracy and handoff completion are measured, not only submission volume.
- Content review performance is visible, including overdue and ownerless items.
- Deferred decisions have a review date and an explicit decision owner.
- The Community Hub governance review produces actions and tracks them to closure.

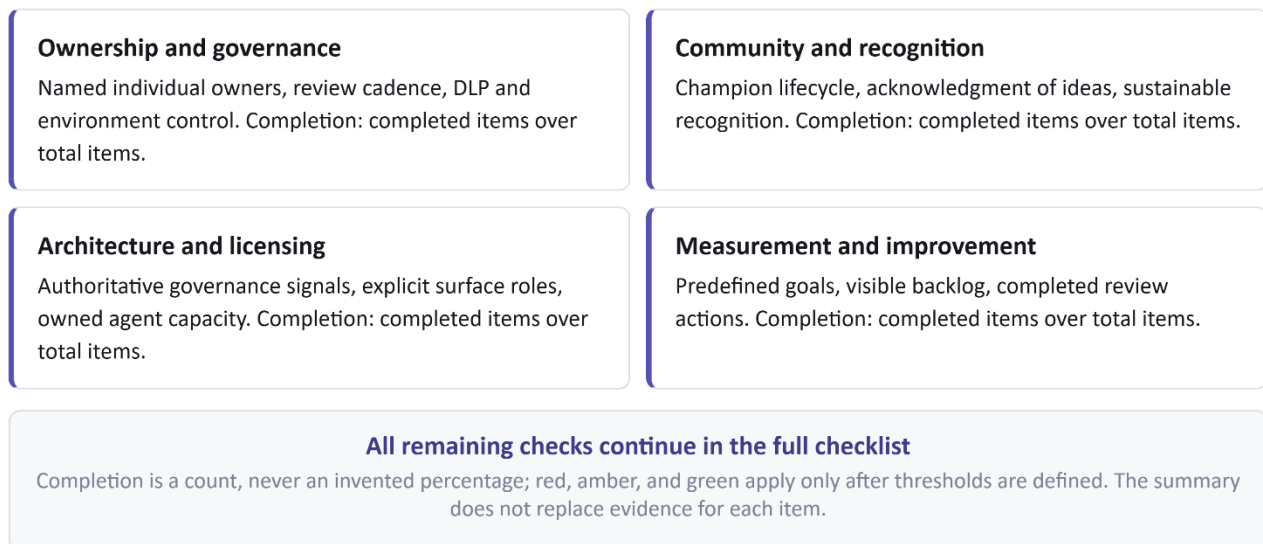


Figure 18. Readiness checklist dashboard.

The checklist is not a certification. An organization may make a defensible decision that an item does not apply, but that decision should be recorded with its rationale and owner. Unanswered is different from not applicable. The goal is to prevent an attractive front end from hiding unresolved operating decisions.

Continue the Series

This paper answered a narrow question: how can the community-facing surface of a Power Platform Center of Excellence be translated into audiences, capabilities, request routes, architecture, mockups, entitlements, implementation phases, and governance checks? The wider framework remains the subject of the Power Platform Center of Excellence book series.



Defining the Framework Structure for the Power Platform Center of Excellence

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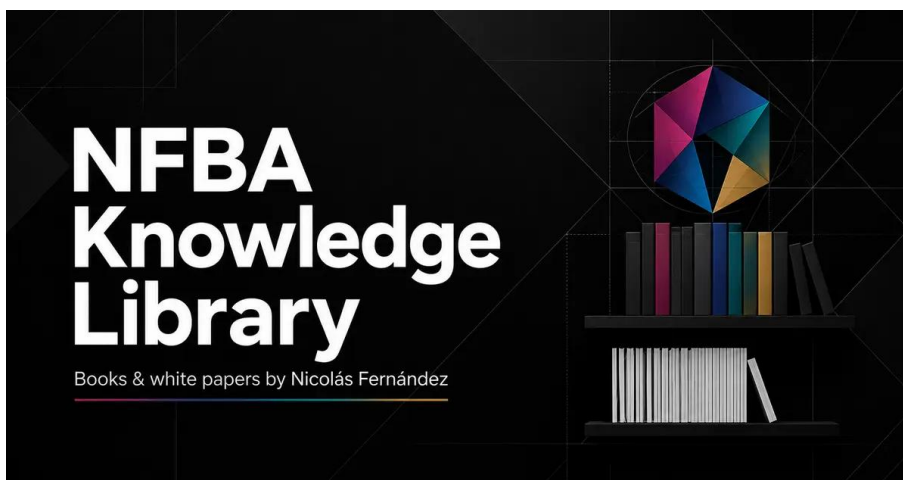
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[View on Amazon ->](#)

<https://www.amazon.com/dp/B0H2SXQ3QQ>

Access to these and more material here:

<https://nfernandezba.github.io/Building-the-Center-of-Excellence-for-Power-Platform/>



14. Sources and provenance

This white paper draws on two source streams. Where Microsoft Learn guidance and the book framework overlap, the design uses official product guidance for product-specific roles and the books for the wider adoption and operating model. Where the books add concepts not expressed in product documentation, including the distinction between the execution layer and the sustainability layer beneath it, and the behavioral dimension of agent adoption, those concepts remain part of the reference design.

Product statements are current to August 2026. Before an implementation decision, the relevant official pages should be checked again because product packaging, documentation, and licensing can change.

Cited Microsoft sources

1. Microsoft Learn, Power Platform CoE Starter Kit transition to Power Platform admin center. Used for the statement that the Starter Kit is no longer actively maintained and that relevant inventory, usage, monitoring, actions, and licensing capabilities have moved to the admin center. <<https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/power-platform/guidance/coe/starter-kit>>
2. Microsoft Learn, Set up tools to support your community. Used for the roles assigned to SharePoint, Viva Engage, and Microsoft Forms in the community-tool model. <<https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/power-platform/guidance/adoption/wiki-community>>
3. Microsoft, Important update to Power Apps per app license. Used for the January 2, 2026 end-of-sale statement and its channel and renewal conditions. <<https://www.microsoft.com/en-us/licensing/news/power-app-per-app-end-of-sale>>
4. Microsoft Learn, Types of Power Automate licenses. Used for the Power Automate Premium and Power Automate Process names. <<https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/power-platform/admin/power-automate-licensing/types>>
5. Microsoft Learn, Copilot Studio licensing. Used for Copilot Credits, Message Pack, Pay-As-You-Go, and the consumption model. <<https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/microsoft-copilot-studio/billing-licensing>>
6. Microsoft Learn, Understand Microsoft Fabric licenses and capacity. Used for Microsoft Fabric F-SKU capacity and Power BI Premium per-capacity P-SKUs. <<https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/fabric/enterprise/licenses>>
7. Microsoft Support, Pin an app in Microsoft Teams. Used for the behavior of pinned applications and overflow visibility described in Chapter 4. <<https://support.microsoft.com/en-us/teams/apps-service/pin-an-app-in-microsoft-teams>>
8. Microsoft Learn, Add more Microsoft Dataverse capacity for your tenant. Used for the Database, File, and Log capacity categories. <<https://learn.microsoft.com/en-us/power-platform/admin/add-storage>>

Further Microsoft Learn background

- Nurture a maker and champion community.
- Nurture your Power Platform community.
- Support Power Platform champions in your organization.
- Adoption maturity model: goals and opportunities.
- Establish a Power Platform Center of Excellence.
- Power Platform licensing FAQs.

Book series

- Nicolás Andrés Fernández, Defining the Framework Structure for the Power Platform Center of Excellence, December 2025. This provides the sustainable adoption model and the framework structure: an execution layer formed by the

Centers of Governance, Innovation, and Enablement, with the Innovation Hub as a point of convergence between the three, and a sustainability layer of operations, support, and maintenance beneath it.

- Nicolás Andrés Fernández, Copilot Studio and the Future of the Power Platform Center of Excellence, May 2026. This provides the agent-era context for training, community, responsible adoption, and enabling assets.